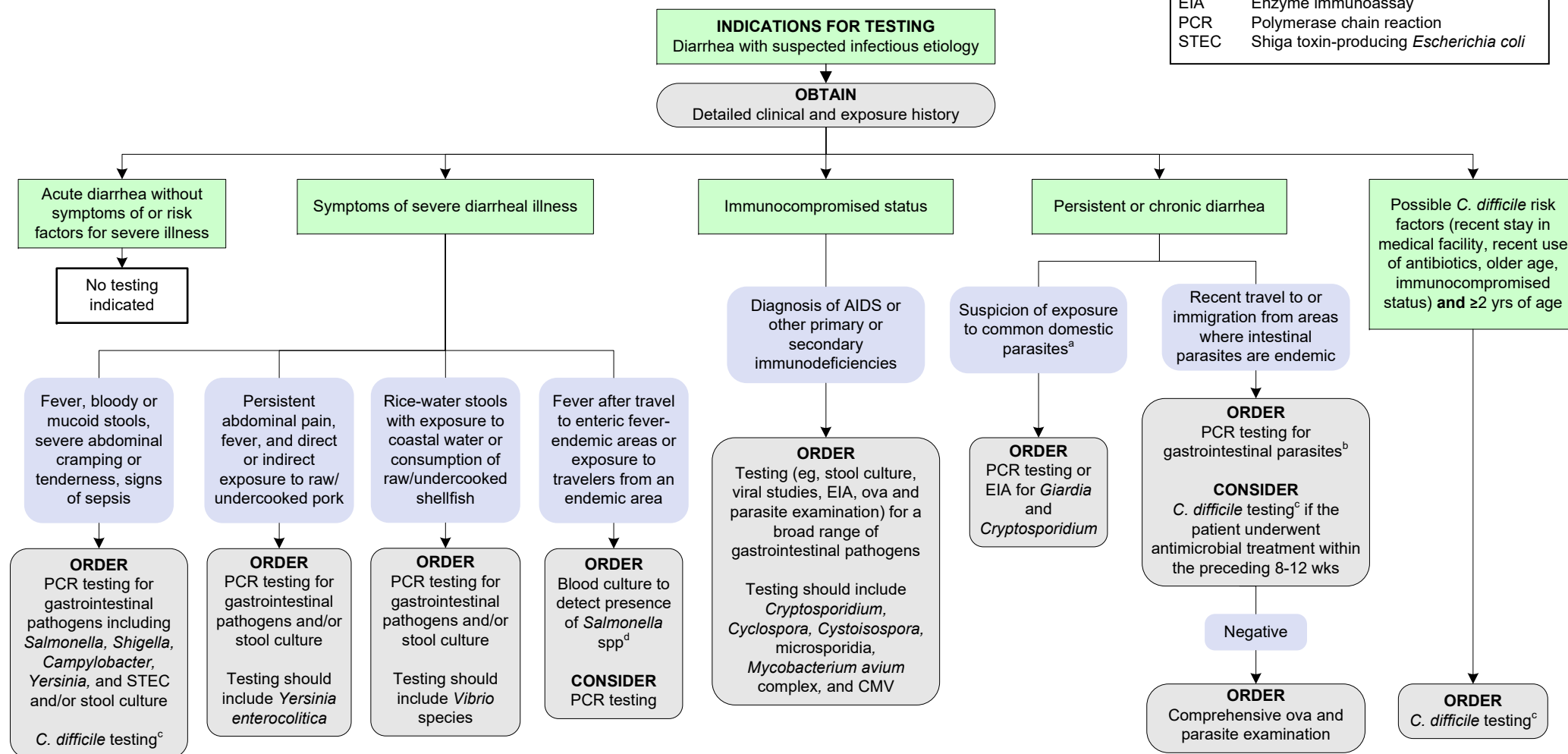


Infectious Diarrhea Testing Algorithm

[Click here for topics associated with this algorithm](#)

Abbreviations

CMV	Cytomegalovirus
EIA	Enzyme immunoassay
PCR	Polymerase chain reaction
STEC	Shiga toxin-producing <i>Escherichia coli</i>



^aPossible sources of exposure include childcare settings, swimming pools, lakes, drinking water from shallow wells, and sexual practices involving anal contact.

^bThe most common parasites causing infectious diarrhea include *Giardia duodenalis*, *Cryptosporidium* spp., *Cyclospora* spp., *Cystoisospora belli*, *Entamoeba histolytica*, and possibly certain strains of *Dientamoeba fragilis* and *Blastocystis* spp.

^cTesting for *C. difficile* may also be considered in patients with persistent diarrhea without an etiology or recognized risk factors. Refer to the [Clostridioides \(Clostridium\) difficile Infection Testing](#) algorithm for more information.

^dMultiple cultures may be needed to isolate the pathogen. Blood, bone marrow, and bile culture have the highest clinical yield.

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